



## Powerwall 2

A revamped version of the popular Powerwall named will be launched soon by Tesla, declared Musk. <http://digit.in/Ver2>



## Morgan Cars

Morgan Motors, best known for producing classic cars is set to launch its hybrid electric cars in next 3 years. <http://digit.in/EMorgan>



# Decoding Netflix's India strategy



Netflix really wants Indians to like them. Where piracy reigns supreme. We sat down with Jonathan Friedland, Chief Communication Officer for Netflix to understand their streaming and content plan for India.

◀ Jonathan Friedland,  
Chief Communication Officer, Netflix

Adamyia Sharma  
[adamyia@digit.in](mailto:adamyia@digit.in)

**Q** Could you tell us what is the response to Netflix in India so far? Do you see a healthy demand for the service so far?

**Friedland:** We've had a lot of free trials. The level of engagement seems to be pretty good, particularly around original programs like Jessica Jones, Daredevil, Narcos, Master of None. But, you know it's the early days right now, we'll see.

**Q** A lot of people are upset about some of Netflix's original content is missing and the content library in India is much smaller than that in the US. We know this could be due to the existing licensing deals with television channels in India. How is Netflix positioned to grow their content library in India?

**Friedland:** There are a couple of different things here. First is, we have been streaming in the United States for 10 years. There are 45 million people paying in the United States for streaming content, so, we can afford a lot more in the United States. Whenever we start out in a new country, and we have launched in 60 countries before we launched in the 130, we have a pretty small catalogue to start with and we add to it pretty consistently over time. So, you can already see a significant increase in what's on the platform since we started.

The reason why we do that is because we want to know what people are watching and we get more on what people want to watch and we do away with the stuff that people are not watching. So over time, you will get a much broader catalogue here.

You know, licensing is still pre-internet. The way it works is that studios license content per territory to one broadcaster. So, with House of Cards for instance, we made HoC 3 years ago when we were only in the US and couple of other countries so we couldn't afford it across the world. So, somebody else licensed it in India.

**Q** Netflix just acquired Brahman Naman, which is a film by an Indian independent director. Is the company looking to invest in more Indian content in the future?

**Friedland:** Yeah, very much so. We have a content licensing team that does that stuff and they are constantly looking for new things. Brahman Naman is interesting because I was at the Sundance Film Festival last week in Utah and a bunch of us saw the movie and loved it. So, we made an offer and luckily they accepted. So, this will be available not only in India on Netflix, but, everywhere else in the world.

**Q** What is Netflix doing to block VPNs and apps like Smart Flix that help users access its entire US library?

**Friedland:** First of all, anybody who has

been using a VPN to access Netflix, it's been against our terms of use forever. What we have done is that we have upgraded the technology alongside Hulu and BBC iplayer and all the other streaming services, because, the people we license content from won't do so unless we respect their territorial rights. That, unfortunately is a business model that was per-internet and the internet has changed a lot of things but that business model still exists and as long as it exists, we have an obligation to protect that territorial integrity.

**Q** Is Netflix implementing local caching servers at the ISP level in India?

**Friedland:** Yeah, we already are. We have local caches and we have our Open Connect servers here in India and we have been working on them for quite sometime.

**Q** Why doesn't Netflix offer the viewer the ability to download videos offline?

**Friedland:** Our business is streaming and we are going to stick to that for now. We have no plans, as of now, for an offline module.

**Q** Any plans for launching a Netflix Stick (like Apple TV) if you find the right OEM?

**Friedland:** No. We're on Apple TV and Chromecast. So, we aren't looking to create our own hardware platform. Never.